

# Maria Silva

38, Marlborough Road, Maidenhead, Berkshire · +447935308070 · mariafgsilva10@gmail.com ·  
linkedin.com/in/mariafgsilva10

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LLB and LLM graduate with hands-on paralegal experience supporting complex disputes and varied legal matters at BCLP, Citizens Advice and Q-Legal. Skilled in document review, preparing hearing bundles, conducting legal research, drafting procedural documents and correspondence, maintaining organised case files and managing competing deadlines. Experienced in communicating with clients on sensitive matters and supporting solicitors with proactive, accurate legal assistance across a fast-paced caseload.

## EDUCATION

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### **Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit** **Sept 2024 – Oct 2025**

Queen Mary University of London

- Modules in international arbitration, dispute resolution, procedural issues, legal research and evidence analysis
- Dissertation on data protection and the development of GDPR across jurisdictions — Distinction, 75%

### **Law LLB — 2:1** **Sept 2020 – June 2024**

University College London

- Modules included Alternative Dispute Resolution, Advanced Contract Law, Commercial Law and Company Law

### **International Foundation Programme in Law and International Relations** **Sept 2019 – June 2020**

King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize (top 20 of a 200-student cohort; partial funding toward undergraduate degree)

## EXPERIENCE

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### **Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London** **Aug 2023 – Feb 2024**

#### **Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration**

- Supported a complex investment arbitration: reviewed and organised evidence for procedural submissions and the Claimant's memorial; amended memorial sections and drafted procedural orders and procedural histories
- Became the only junior supporting the team shortly before a significant submission deadline: coordinated documents, tracked outstanding actions and helped ensure on-time delivery
- Maintained structured electronic case files and monitored procedural deadlines throughout the matter
- Liaised with the client on required documents; coordinated Romanian translations with an external translator
- Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

### **Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London** **Feb 2024 – Aug 2024**

#### **Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes**

- Supported hearing preparation: reviewed documents, prepared electronic bundles and assisted with skeleton arguments and court materials
- Conducted legal and factual research across rights of light, easements, leasehold issues and landlord and tenant disputes
- Assisted with court filings, hearing arrangements, matter opening and closure, deadline tracking and cost comparisons
- Managed large volumes of confidential documents across several matters with competing deadlines; maintained matter records via iManage
- Prepared client notes and internal summaries to support supervising solicitors

**Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead****July 2026 – Present****Legal Adviser**

- Manages matters from initial client interview through to submission: drafts correspondence, prepares applications and document schedules, maintains confidential case records and meets deadlines
- Interviews clients across welfare, employment, housing, family, debt and consumer matters; takes detailed factual statements, establishes chronologies and identifies relevant legal and evidential issues
- Assesses eligibility against statutory and regulatory criteria; identifies evidential gaps and researches complex points of law
- Advises clients on procedural requirements and options, translating complex rules into clear, practical guidance for vulnerable individuals

**Q-Legal · London****Oct 2024 – Jan 2025****Legal Adviser**

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction through to a formal written advice letter under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations, including children's personal data and adtech, and identified compliance risks from the client's data processing
- Translated complex statutory requirements into clear, commercially focused advice; coordinated with the client and supervising solicitor to meet the agreed deadline

**Adobe · London****June 2022 – Aug 2022****Legal Intern**

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with internal legal and compliance requirements
- Reviewed confidentiality and data-processing provisions; researched UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border personal data transfer obligations
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries and reconcile commercial objectives with legal risk
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

**SKILLS**

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**Languages:** Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

**Technical skills:** Legal and commercial research; document review; electronic bundling; drafting correspondence and procedural documents; concise report writing; Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; iManage; legal research databases; electronic court filing portals; case management and time-recording systems

**Case and evidence management:** Evidence review, hearing bundle preparation, procedural histories, case-file organisation, deadline tracking across multiple concurrent matters